

D384

Marketing Experiential Capstone

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

Midway through a six-week social media project for a local brewery, the owner asks the student team to also redesign the website “while you’re at it.” The brewery just won a regional beer award. What is the best response?

- A. Say yes right away to keep the client happy.
- B. Feature the beer award in the new website design.
- C. Refuse, because scope can never change once a project starts.
- D. Acknowledge the request, assess its effect on time and quality, and agree on a documented change or trade-off before starting.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A client approves a change adding two deliverables but keeps the same deadline and team size. Which project constraint is most at risk?

- A. Only the client’s satisfaction with the brand
- B. Cost, which will go down
- C. Quality, because more work must fit the same time and people
- D. None, since the client approved the change

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A marketing team learns that a vendor will deliver the campaign videos a week late, which will push back the launch. The next client meeting is in 10 days, and the client’s office is across town. What should the project lead do?

- A. Wait and raise it at the meeting in 10 days.
- B. Say nothing and try to make up the time.
- C. Tell the client now, explaining the impact and offering options.
- D. Drive to the client’s office, since in-person news is always required.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

Two teammates disagree about whether a campaign should focus on TikTok or email. Both have supporting data, and the choice matters to the client. The team meets in a library study room. Which conflict approach fits best?

- A. Avoiding: drop the topic to keep the peace.
- B. Collaborating: examine both sets of data to find a solution that meets both goals.
- C. Accommodating: one teammate gives in to end the argument.
- D. Let the loudest person decide, since conflict is always harmful.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

When is avoiding an appropriate conflict-handling style?

- A. When the issue is minor or people need time to cool down first
- B. When a quick, firm decision is needed in an emergency
- C. When the issue is critical to both parties
- D. Never; avoiding is always wrong

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A marketing coordinator has a client press release due today, a portfolio refresh for her promotion review next month, a group chat about lunch plans, and a coworker's unplanned request to reformat his slides. Her usual coffee order is a flat white. After the press release, what should she protect time for?

- A. The lunch group chat
- B. Scheduled time for the portfolio refresh
- C. The coworker's slide request, because it is urgent
- D. Whatever request arrives next, since tasks should always go in order received

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Using the urgent-important matrix, what should usually happen to tasks that are urgent but not important?

- A.** Delegate them
- B.** Do them first yourself
- C.** Schedule them for later
- D.** Delete them

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A marketing graduate wants a B2B content-marketing role. Her profile headline says “Open to any job,” and her portfolio mostly shows event photos. She has 900 connections and plays in a weekend soccer league. What is the best personal-branding move?

- A.** Grow to 2,000 connections before changing anything.
- B.** Lead her portfolio with soccer-league photos to show teamwork.
- C.** Keep it broad, since narrowing always limits options.
- D.** Rewrite her headline and portfolio around B2B content samples that match the target role.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A new client, a family-owned hardware store with three locations and a 50-year history, asks the team to “do some Instagram.” What should the team do first?

- A.** Design a 50th-anniversary logo.
- B.** Start posting daily right away.
- C.** Recommend TikTok instead, since it is trending.
- D.** Hold a discovery session to clarify business goals, target customers, budget, and how success will be measured.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A team lead needs to address a teammate who missed two deadlines. The teammate is also the team's strongest designer. Which feedback follows the situation-behavior-impact model?

- A. Raise it in the team group chat so everyone learns from it.
- B. "In Tuesday's and Thursday's handoffs, the copy drafts came in after the deadline, which pushed our client review back a day. What got in the way?"
- C. "You're always late and unreliable."
- D. "Your designs are great—keep it up."

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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11.

On a campaign that will run in four cities, three people each believe they have final sign-off on the ad copy, and approvals have stalled. What is the best fix?

- A. Build a RACI chart naming one Accountable approver, with the others Consulted or Informed.
- B. Assign a different approver for each city.
- C. Make all three people Accountable.
- D. Remove the approval step entirely.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In a RACI chart, which role does the actual work on a task?

- A. Accountable
- B. Informed
- C. Responsible
- D. Consulted

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

Midway through a six-week social media project for a local brewery, the owner asks the student team to also redesign the website “while you’re at it.” ~~The brewery just won a regional beer award.~~ What is the best response?

Target word: handling a scope request **Decides:** An unplanned deliverable mid-project.

A	Dropped element	Drops the impact assessment; risks missing the original deliverables.
B	Camouflage	Answers the award detail, not the scope question.
C	Absolute language	Scope can change through a proper change process.
D	Correct	Change control protects the project and the relationship.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

A client approves a change adding two deliverables but keeps the same deadline and team size. Which project constraint is most at risk?

Target word: reverse: from change to risk **Decides:** Scope grows while time and resources stay fixed.

A	Adjacent category	Satisfaction is an outcome, not a project constraint.
B	Inverted operation	More work does not lower cost.
C	Correct	When scope rises and time and resources are fixed, quality absorbs the strain.
D	Dropped element	Approval does not remove the workload.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A marketing team learns that a vendor will deliver the campaign videos a week late, which will push back the launch. The next client meeting is in 10 days, ~~and the client’s office is across town.~~ What should the project lead do?

Target word: when and how to tell the client **Decides:** A known delay affecting the launch.

A	Dropped element	Drops urgency; the client loses time to adjust.
B	Inverted operation	Hiding the delay damages trust when it surfaces.
C	Correct	Early bad news with options keeps trust and choices open.
D	Absolute language	Speed matters more than format here.

4. Answer B Concept 3

Two teammates disagree about whether a campaign should focus on TikTok or email. Both have supporting data, and the choice matters to the client. ~~The team meets in a library study room.~~ Which conflict approach fits best?

Target word: best conflict style **Decides:** High stakes and valid concerns on both sides.

A	Confusion set	Leaves an important decision unmade.
B	Correct	Best when the issue is important and both concerns matter.
C	Adjacent category	Loses one side’s valid data.
D	Absolute language	Conflict handled well improves decisions.

5. Answer A Concept 3 • transfer

When is avoiding an appropriate conflict-handling style?

Target word: reverse: from style to situation **Decides:** Low importance or a need to cool down.

A	Correct	Avoiding fits trivial issues or heated moments.
B	Confusion set	That calls for competing (directing).
C	Inverted operation	Important issues call for collaborating.
D	Absolute language	It has a place for trivial issues.

6. Answer B Concept 4

A marketing coordinator has a client press release due today, a portfolio refresh for her promotion review next month, a group chat about lunch plans, and a coworker's unplanned request to reformat his slides. ~~Her usual coffee order is a flat white.~~ After the press release, what should she protect time for?

Target word: next priority **Decides:** The portfolio is important but not urgent.

A	Inverted operation	Neither urgent nor important.
B	Correct	Important-not-urgent work is what gets crowded out unless protected.
C	Confusion set	Urgent but not important to her goals; delegate or limit it.
D	Absolute language	Arrival order ignores importance.

7. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

Using the urgent-important matrix, what should usually happen to tasks that are urgent but not important?

Target word: reverse: from quadrant to action **Decides:** Urgent, not important.

A	Correct	They need doing soon, but not by you.
B	Inverted operation	That is the rule for urgent and important tasks.
C	Adjacent category	That is for important but not urgent tasks.
D	Confusion set	That is for tasks that are neither urgent nor important.

8. Answer D Concept 5

A marketing graduate wants a B2B content-marketing role. Her profile headline says "Open to any job," and her portfolio mostly shows event photos. She has 900 connections ~~and plays in a weekend soccer league.~~ What is the best personal-branding move?

Target word: branding move **Decides:** Profile does not match the target role.

A	Wrong stem number	Connection count does not fix the mismatch.
B	Camouflage	Unrelated to the target role.
C	Absolute language	Broad branding shows no clear value to any employer.
D	Correct	A focused, consistent brand shows fit for the role she wants.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A new client, a family-owned hardware store ~~with three locations and a 50-year history~~, asks the team to “do some Instagram.” What should the team do first?

Target word: first step with a new client **Decides:** The ask has no objective, audience, or measure.

A	Camouflage	Answers the history detail, not the need.
B	Dropped element	Drops the objectives that should guide the posts.
C	Adjacent category	Another tactic chosen without discovery.
D	Correct	Tactics should follow objectives.

10. Answer B Concept 7

A team lead needs to address a teammate who missed two deadlines. ~~The teammate is also the team's strongest designer.~~ Which feedback follows the situation-behavior-impact model?

Target word: best feedback wording **Decides:** Specific situation, behavior, impact, plus an invitation.

A	Adjacent category	Corrective feedback belongs in private.
B	Correct	Names situation, behavior, and impact, then invites dialogue.
C	Absolute language	Labels the person and uses “always.”
D	Camouflage	Praises the unrelated strength and avoids the issue.

11. Answer A Concept 8

On a campaign ~~that will run in four cities~~, three people each believe they have final sign-off on the ad copy, and approvals have stalled. What is the best fix?

Target word: fix stalled approvals **Decides:** More than one person thinks they decide.

A	Correct	One Accountable owner per decision ends the deadlock.
B	Camouflage	Answers the city detail; the copy still has no single owner.
C	Inverted operation	That makes the problem official.
D	Dropped element	Drops quality control instead of clarifying roles.

12. Answer C Concept 8 · transfer

In a RACI chart, which role does the actual work on a task?

Target word: reverse: from action to role **Decides:** Doing the work.

A	Confusion set	Owens the outcome and signs off; may not do the work.
B	Inverted operation	Only receives updates after the fact.
C	Correct	Responsible people complete the task.
D	Adjacent category	Gives input before or during the work.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	7	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Scope change control	New requests mid-project are assessed for impact on time, cost, and quality and agreed through a documented change before work begins.	Saying yes on the spot to please the client, or refusing all change.	"While you're at it" requests after the plan is set.
2	Proactive stakeholder communication	Share bad news early with its impact and options; do not wait for the next scheduled meeting.	Hiding a problem and hoping to catch up.	A known delay with a meeting still days away.
3	Conflict-handling styles	Collaborate when the issue matters and both sides' concerns are valid; avoid only when the issue is trivial or tempers need to cool.	Avoiding or giving in on an issue that matters.	How important the issue is and how much each side's concern counts.
4	Urgent vs. important	Do urgent-and-important work first, protect time for important-but-not-urgent work, delegate urgent-but-unimportant tasks, and drop the rest.	Letting urgent but unimportant requests crowd out important work.	A task list mixing deadlines, interruptions, and long-term goals.
5	Personal branding	A personal brand is a focused, consistent message of the value you offer to a target employer, shown across your profile and portfolio.	Staying so broad that no employer sees a fit.	A target role plus a profile that does not match it.
6	Discovery before tactics	Clarify the client's objective, audience, budget, and success measures before choosing channels or creative.	Jumping straight to posting or to a trendy channel.	A vague client ask like "do some social media."
7	Situation-behavior-impact feedback	Useful feedback names the specific situation, the observable behavior, and its impact, then invites a response.	Labeling the person ("always," "unreliable") or giving feedback in public.	"How should the lead raise it?"
8	RACI role clarity	Each task has exactly one Accountable owner; Responsible people do the work, Consulted give input, Informed are kept updated.	Making several people accountable for the same decision.	Stalled approvals because several people think they decide.

Course scope (public description): Marketing Experiential Capstone is the capstone course for the program that provides learners with real- world applications to prepare them for the marketing industry. In this course, learners will integrate and apply marketing skills gained throughout the program by working with an organization on a marketing project. Marketers must effectively manage many relationships throughout their career with clients and team members in an organization, an agency, or their own marketing firm. This course allows students to apply their technical knowledge while also developing competencies in effective communication, collaboration, conflict management, project management, and time management power skills. Learners will explore their professional goals and develop a personal branding strategy to enhance their marketability and to strategically plan for their marketing career.